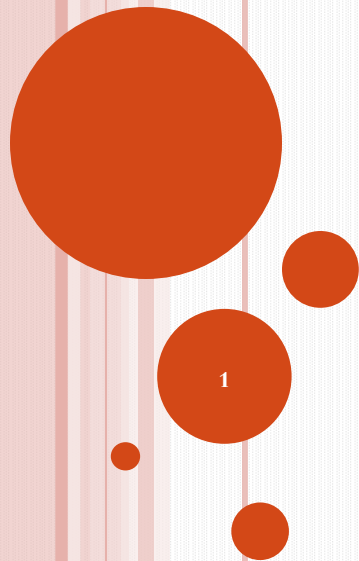


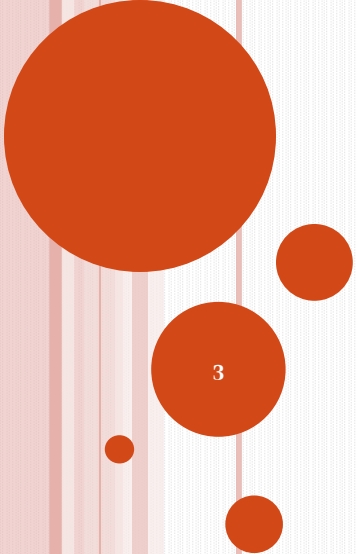
LECTURE 2: PSYCHOLOGICAL RESEARCH INVESTIGATION

ASSOC. PROF. KULLAYA PISITSUNGKAGARN, PH.D. & DPsYCH



OUTLINE FOR THE LECTURE

- An Empirical Study of Psychology:
 - Empirical/Research investigations in psychology
 - Ethical considerations in psychological research
- Administrative Works:
 - Topic & scheduling for application project presentation



AN EMPIRICAL STUDY OF PSYCHOLOGY

3

AN EMPIRICAL STUDY OF PSYCHOLOGY

- Despite their different foci, all domains in psychology are evidence-based, or based on empirical research evidence.
- Still, with some of the questions addressed by psychology being so common in our daily living, why can't we simply use our common senses/intuitions to address these problems?
 - Example: What contribute(s) to happiness?



ACTIVITY 1: PERSONAL REFLECTION



1



2



3



4



12



11

Being Young

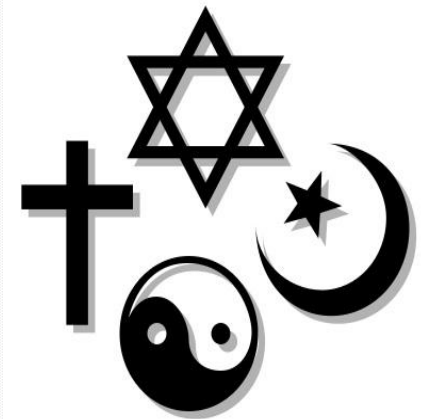
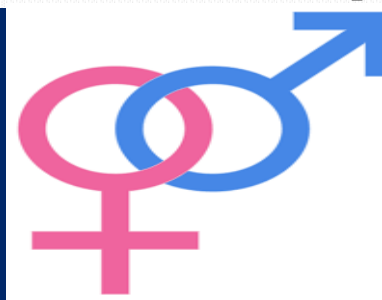
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AN EMPIRICAL STUDY OF PSYCHOLOGY

- Our intuitions/unique experiences differ and are not always accurate.
- It is inaccurate to make a conclusion based on our intuitions or unique experiences in the study of psychology.



EMPIRICAL EVIDENCE OF PSYCHOLOGY

[illegible]

- 8

AN EMPIRICAL NATURE OF PSYCHOLOGY

- Promised benefits of an empirical study in psychology:
 - 1) Clarity and precision
 - 2) Relatively low errors
 - 3) Reviews by other researchers



PROMISED BENEFITS OF AN EMPIRICAL STUDY

Happiness is ...



Loving yourself!

- 1) Clarity & precision
 - Research investigations demand a clear definition of the psychological construct, or the concept, to be studied.
 - In class activity, we might identify different causes of happiness because we defined the construct differently.

Happiness Is When
What You Think
What You Say
And What You Do
Are In Harmony

Roberto Gombi - www.gombi.com

*“For me,
happiness
is the joy we feel
striving for
our potential”*

- Shawn Achor

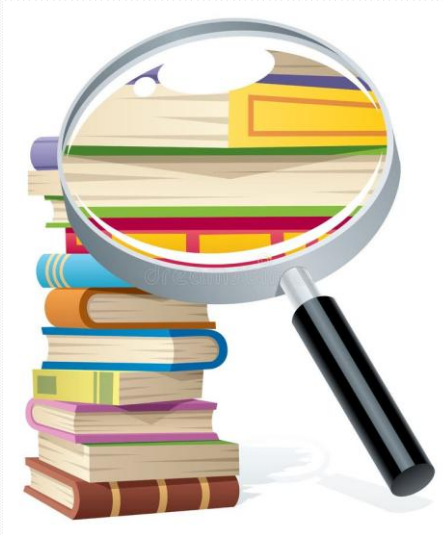
HAPPINESS
IS A
Journey
NOT A
DESTINATION



Happiness is homemade

PROMISED BENEFITS OF AN EMPIRICAL STUDY

- 1) Clarity & precision
 - When a research study is conducted, the construct “happiness” needs to be clearly defined.
 - The definition comes from past literature review.



PROMISED BENEFITS OF AN EMPIRICAL STUDY



*“For me,
happiness
is the joy we feel
striving for
our potential”*

- Shawn Achor

- 1) Clarity & precision
 - Two common definitions relevant to happiness:
 - Subjective well-being (hedonic): Positive feelings and the satisfaction that one has regarding one's life qualities.
 - Psychological well-being (Eudaimonic): Living a life with virtue and actualizing one's inherent potentials

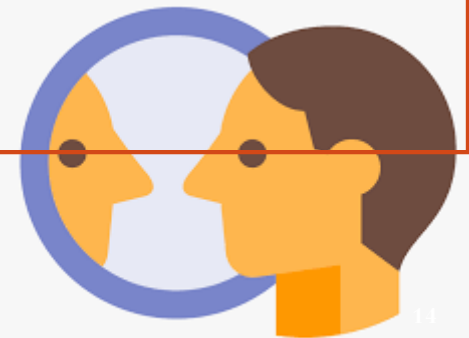
ACTIVITY 2: SELF-ASSESSMENT

- Life Satisfaction: Using the link below to access Diener et al.'s The Satisfaction with Life Scale (1985) to evaluate how much you feel satisfied with your life:
 - https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSeKQyH9DU6fkEmlgVt2HLIOtnw3OjF8pwyIaHH5OqXB_iod4w/viewform?fbzx=41851628761848846
 - Please rate your agreement to each statement on a scale of 1 (strongly disagree) - 7 (strongly agree).



ACTIVITY 2: SELF-ASSESSMENT

- Diener et al.'s The Satisfaction with Life Scale (1985)
 - Scoring interpretation:
 - 30-35: Extremely satisfied
 - 25-29: Highly satisfied
 - 20-24: Moderately satisfied
 - 15-19: Slightly dissatisfied
 - 10-14: Dissatisfied
 - 5-9: Extremely dissatisfied



PROMISED BENEFITS OF RESEARCH STUDIES

- 2) Relatively low errors due to a systematic research procedure:
 - Research questions and hypotheses are proposed based on a literature review.
 - Relevant data are collected in the real world.
 - Data are analyzed rigorously to see whether the hypotheses are supported.



PROMISED BENEFITS OF RESEARCH STUDIES

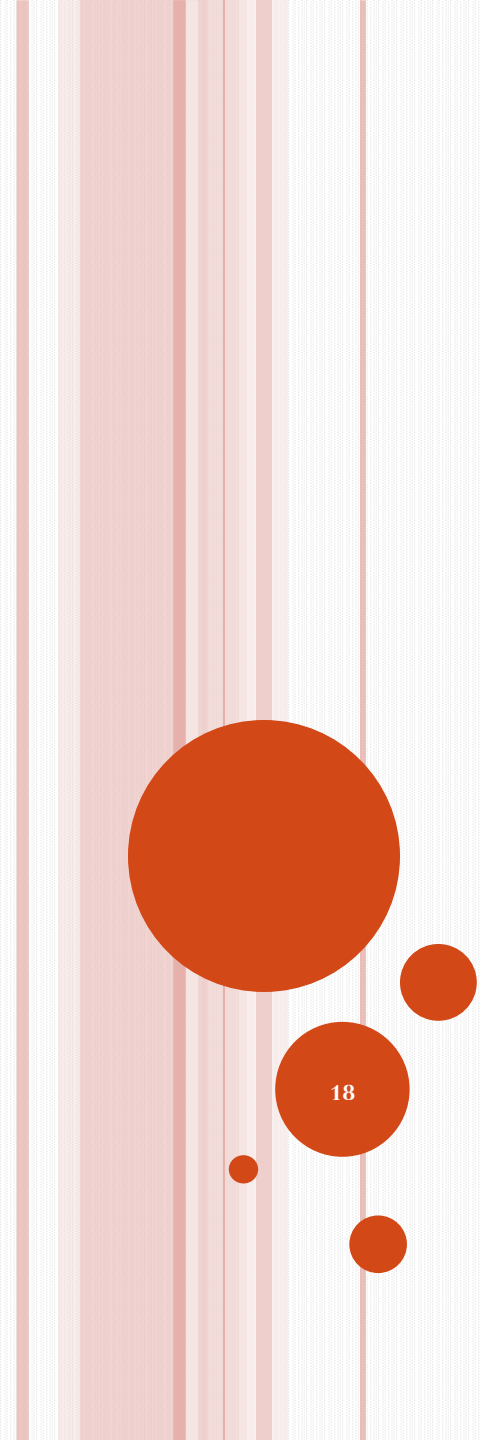
- 3) Reviews by other researchers
 - Legitimate research outcomes are published in peer-reviewed journals.
 - The publications are reviewed and approved by psychologists specialized in that domain.
 - These give credibility to the study outcomes.



PROMISED BENEFITS OF RESEARCH STUDIES

- Despite the promised benefits of an empirical/research study, cautions need to be taken for there is:
 - No perfect knowledge about the mind
 - No perfect way to study the mind
 - No perfect research investigations



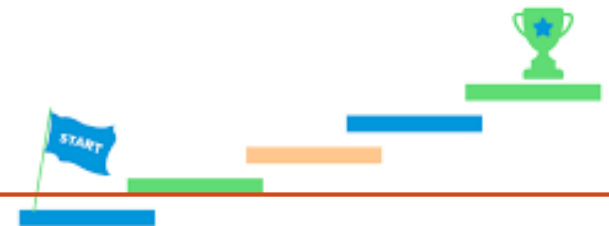
A decorative graphic on the left side of the slide. It features several vertical lines in shades of light orange and red. Overlaid on these lines are several solid orange circles of different sizes. One large circle is positioned near the top, and several smaller circles are arranged below it, some overlapping the lines.

RESEARCH INVESTIGATIONS

18

STEPS FOR RESEARCH INVESTIGATIONS

- Various steps involved in research study include:
 - 1) Define a psychological construct(s) in the question (i.e., study variable(s)) and form research questions & hypotheses
 - 2) Select an appropriate research design
 - 3) Select an appropriate research tool for data collection
 - 4) Conduct data analysis
 - 5) Report finding outcomes
 - 6) Make sure that all are done within the ethical standards



STEPS FOR RESEARCH INVESTIGATIONS

- Tim is planning a happiness research. Pls match his plans with relevant research procedures.

Relevant Procedures	Tim's Plans
___ 1) Form a research question	a. He'll conduct a survey, not an observation, in his study.
___ 2) Define a psychological construct	b. He'll choose subjective, not psychological, well-being concept of happiness.
___ 3) Select a method for data collection	c. He'll ask for a permission for research participation from the children's parents.
___ 4) Select a research tool	d. He'll calculate the rating each object receives and compare the ratings among them.
___ 5) Conduct data analysis	e. He'll investigate, "What bring about happiness in KG students?"
___ 6) Make sure that all are done within the ethical standards.	f. He'll show various objects to a child and ask him to rate each object based on the different degrees of smiley faces which reflect how happy he feels seeing the object.

STEPS FOR RESEARCH INVESTIGATIONS

- Tom is planning an aggression research. Pls match his plans with relevant research procedures.

Relevant Procedures	Tom's Plans
___ 1) Form a research question	a. He'll investigate, "What trigger physical aggression in KG male students?"
___ 2) Define a psychological construct	b. He'll observe the students at playgrounds, note their aggressive behaviors, and identify what trigger(s) such behaviors.
___ 3) Select a method for data collection	c. He'll list and calculate the frequency for each trigger identified.
___ 4) Select a research tool	d. He'll ask for a permission for research participation from the children's parents.
___ 5) Conduct data analysis	e. He'll conduct an observation, not a survey, in his study.
___ 6) Make sure that all is done within the ethical standards.	f. He'll focus on the physical aggression, not cyberbullying, in this group of participants.

RESEARCH METHODS IN PSYCHOLOGY

RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY



- Various research designs are used in psychological research.
- Those commonly used include:
 - A case study design
 - An experimental study design
 - A correlational study design

SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 1) CASE STUDY

- A detailed, generally longitudinal, portrait of one or a few participants on a study variable, including some new/rare disorders or treatment innovations.
 - Interviews, observations, and record checking are often used.
- Example:
 - Studying Ted's rare illness or aggression across his lifespan.



SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 1) CASE STUDY

○ Evaluations:

- Pros: Detailed with changes being chronicled, informative in describing a rarely existing phenomenon
- Cons: The information obtained may be unique to Ted, not applicable to others, & significant resources required for data collection (e.g., time, budget).



SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 2) EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN

- A researcher manipulates one study variable (i.e., an independent variable) to see whether the manipulation leads to change(s) in another variable (i.e., a dependent variable) as a result.
- Data obtained are used for statistical analyses. So, this design generally includes more participants than a case study.



SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 2) EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN

- Sample research question:
 - Would exposing students to different levels of stress lead them to exhibit different levels of aggression?
 - Independent variable (IV): _____
 - Dependent variable (DV): _____
 - ***NB:** Be mindful of the ethical consideration of this study.*



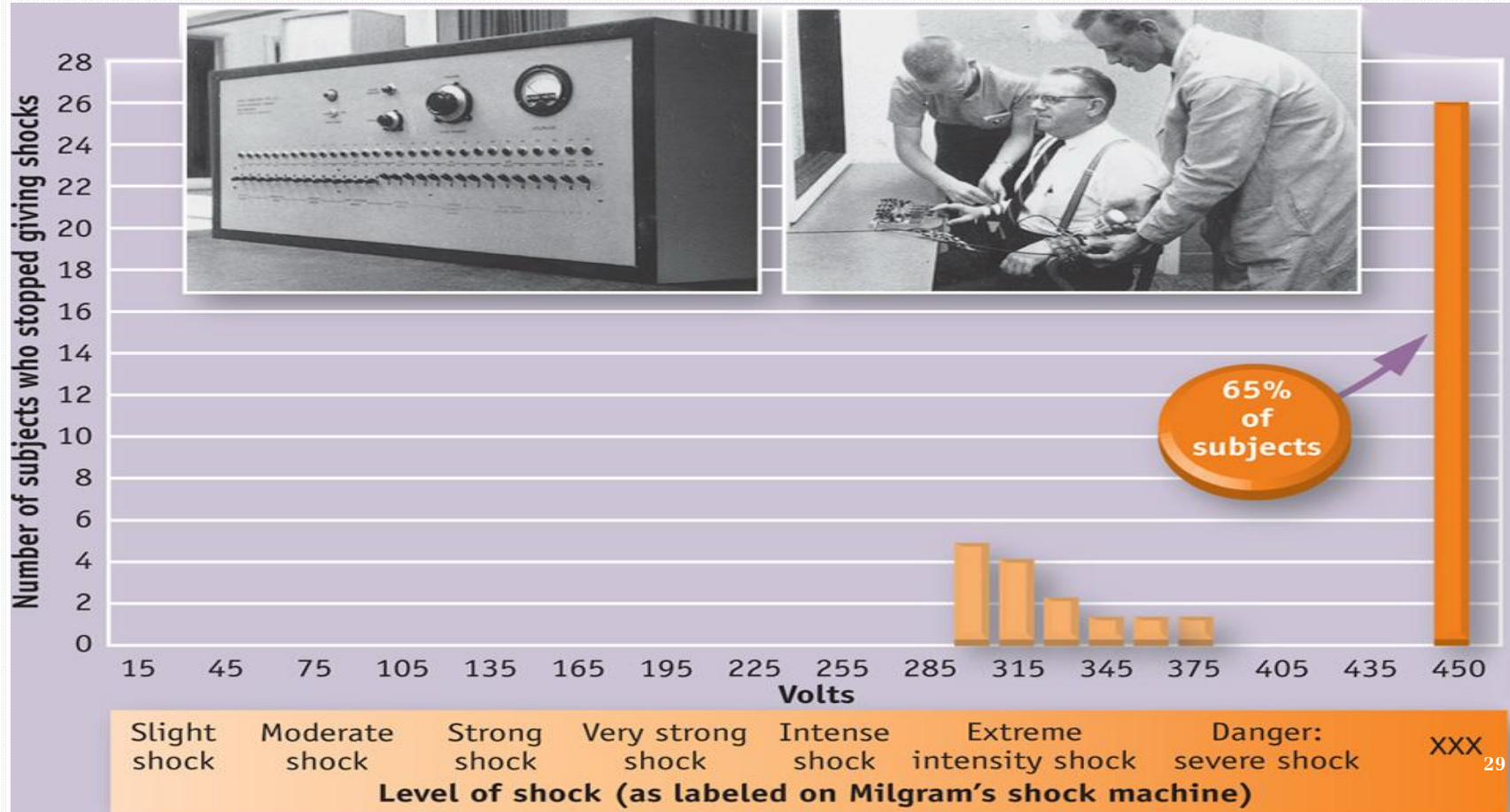
SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 2) EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN



- Another example of experimental research: Milgram's study (1961) (*Ethically controversial*)
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xOYLCy5PVgM>:
 - An experimental study of how environmental/social factor(s) could impact one's level of obedience to authority.

SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 2) EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN

- Experimental research: Milgram's study (1961)



SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 2) EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN

- Sample experimental research: Milgram's study (1961):
 - Would the level of obedience changes if
 - The instruction is given by an authority or a non-authority figure?
 - A dissenter/protester is present?



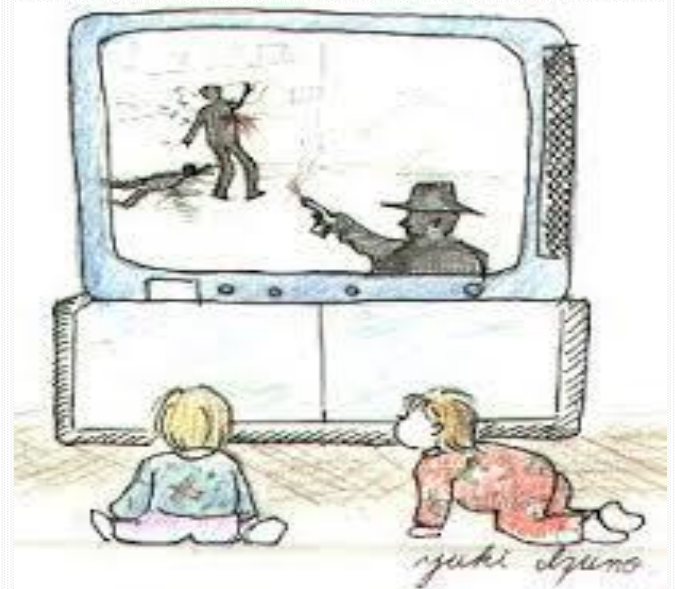
SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 2) EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN

- Advantage:
 - Conclusions about the cause and effect can be drawn.
- Disadvantage:
 - Some variables cannot be manipulated/controlled for ethical reasons.

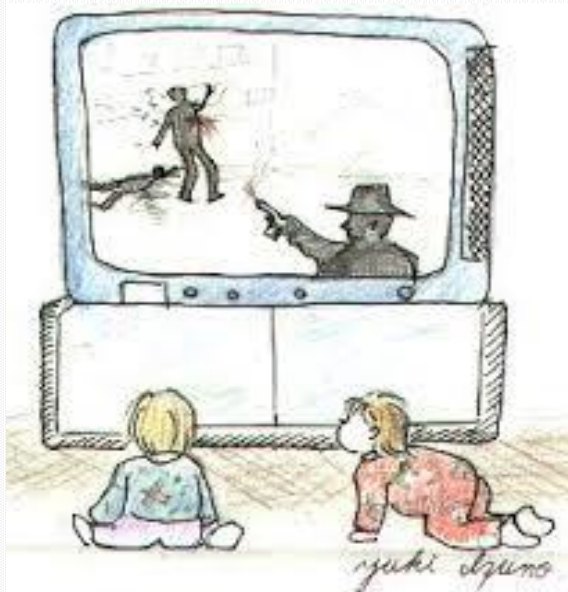


SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 3) CORRELATIONAL STUDY

- Examining association(s) between two or more variables.
- Example: Would there be an association between the number of hours of TV violence exposure and childhood aggression?



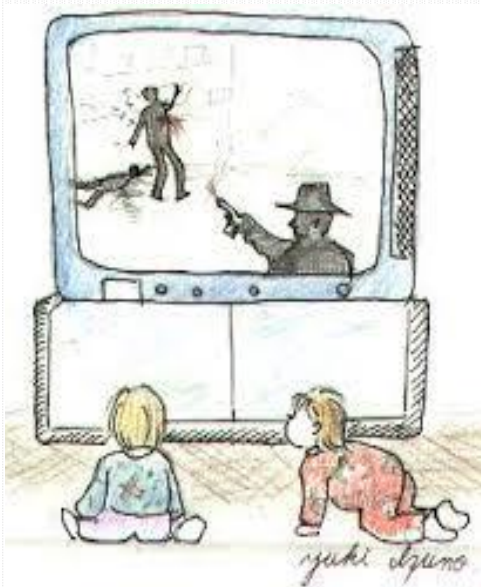
SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 3) CORRELATIONAL STUDY



- Correlation exists if a change in one variable is associated with a change in the other variable.
 - Changes in the number of hours watching TV
 - Changes in the levels of aggression

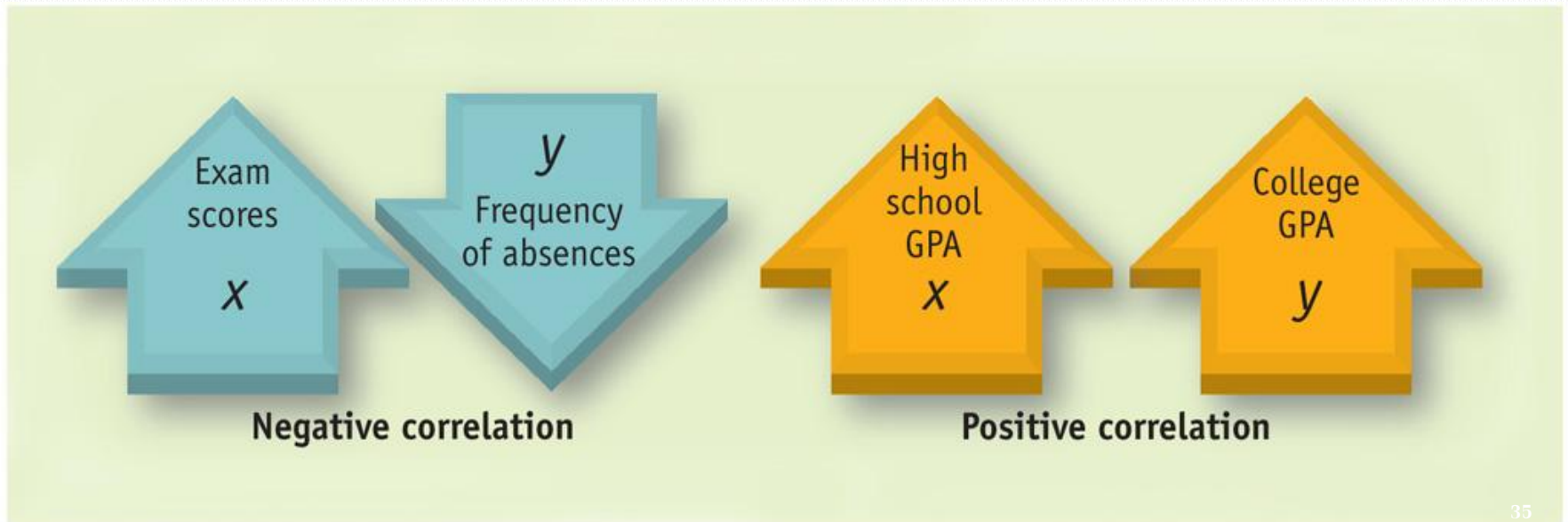
SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 3) CORRELATIONAL STUDY

- Factors to consider
 - The directions of the relationships:
 - Positive: The more hours of TV violence exposure, the more aggressive the children become.
 - Negative: The more hours of TV violence exposure, the less aggressive the children become.
 - Which direction is more likely, positive or negative correlation?



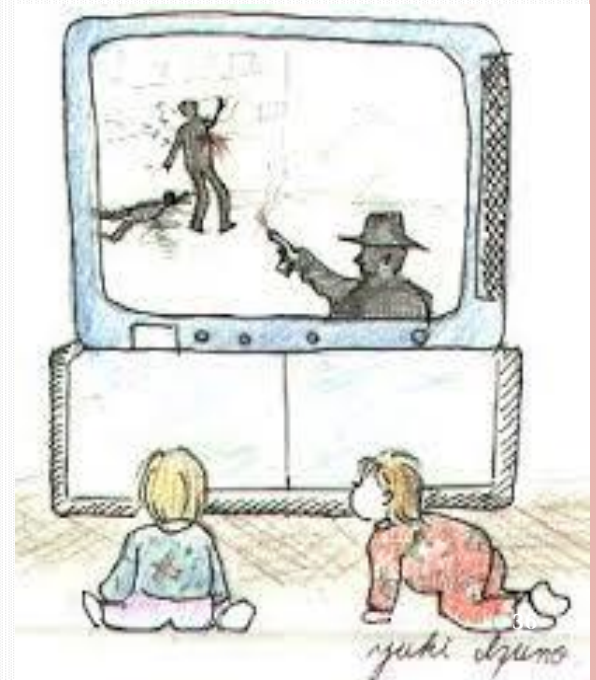
SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 3) CORRELATIONAL STUDY

- Correlational Research: Investigating the association(s) between two or more variables



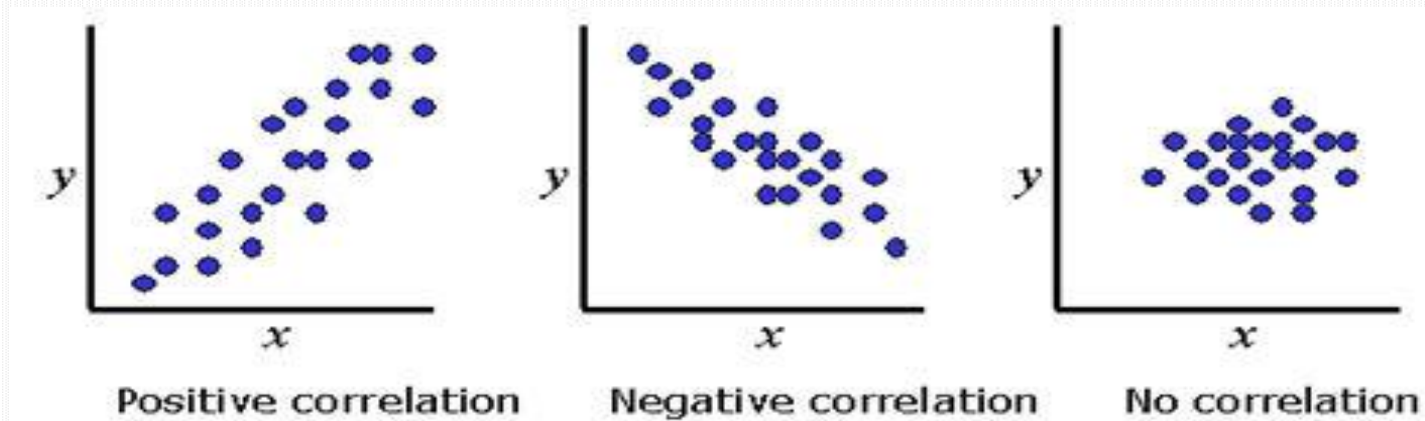
SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 3) CORRELATIONAL STUDY

- Factors to consider
 - How strongly the two variables are correlated results in the size of the correlation:
 - The stronger, the bigger the correlation.
 - The weaker, the smaller the correlation.



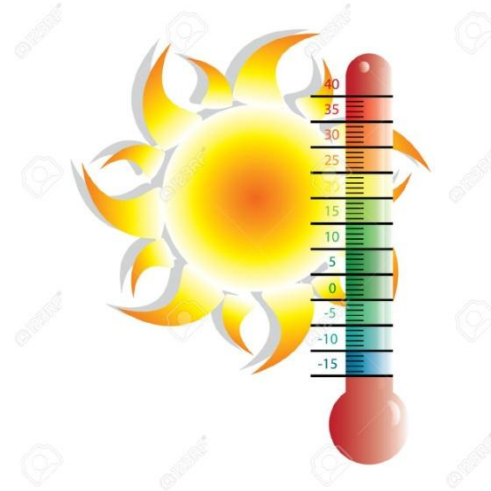
SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 3) CORRELATIONAL STUDY

- Advantages
 - Correlational studies allow the investigations of a broader array of psychological phenomena than experimental studies.



SAMPLE RESEARCH DESIGNS IN PSYCHOLOGY: 3) CORRELATIONAL STUDY

- Disadvantages
 - Correlations only indicate the associations between two study variables, not implying the cause-and-effect relationship (i.e., causal relationship).
 - A third variable could cause the association.



PSYCHOLOGICAL INVESTIGATION & ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

- To ensure the wellness of research participants, research investigations will be first reviewed by ethics committees.
- Participants will be informed about the study's scope, risks & benefits.
 - Informed consent needs to be obtained.
- Their participation is voluntary & they can withdraw from the study at any time.
- Their privacy will be maintained. Research outcomes will not be linked directly to the participants.

